



Delaware County Council Meeting November 23rd 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-5p5eQa9JwQ
Publication Date	2021-11-23T16:12:22Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 16, 2021

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer following a brief technical delay **00:00:10**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Lassetter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Webb, and Mr. Alexander (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not detailed in the transcript.

- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the October 26 meeting were approved following a motion by Ms. Piper and a second by Mr. Ballard, confirmed via roll call vote (Yes: Ballard, Lasseter, Piper, Webb, Alexander) [00:00:18](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:00:47](#) **Resolution 2021-050: Addendum to Interlocal Agreement for Joint Communication Center**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by the Council/Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This item extends the interlocal agreement for the joint communication center between the city and the county for an additional year through the end of next year at a payment amount of \$800,000. Council members noted difficulties in negotiations due to the city's financial troubles, but expressed relief that a one-year extension could be agreed upon rather than reaching an impasse.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote (Yes: Lasseter, Piper, Webb, Ballard, Alexander) [00:03:33](#).
- [00:04:03](#) **Financial Transfers and Addendums Agenda**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department representatives and financial staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and voted on multiple departmental budget transfers and addendums to balance line items through the end of the year:
 - **Circuit Court Department A:** Transfers totaling \$0 (adjusting court reporter, secretary, court-ordered attorney, and office equipment lines). *Approved by roll call* [00:04:59](#).
 - **Communication:** Transfer of \$13,161.05 within communication tech lines. *Approved by roll call* [00:05:42](#).
 - **Public Defender:** Transfers utilizing leftover salary and health insurance funds to cover office supplies (\$3,550) for mandatory client discovery copies. *Approved by roll call* [00:07:07](#).
 - **Jail (Cook lines):** Transfer of \$3,406.60 within cook salary/contract lines. *Approved by roll call* [00:07:49](#).
 - **Sheriff:** Transfers adjusting deputy, sergeant, and sheriff lines. *Approved by roll call* [00:08:39](#).
 - **Highway:** Transfer of \$30,000 from part-time to overtime in preparation for winter snow removal operations, plus truck driver line adjustments. *Approved by roll call* [00:09:53](#).
 - **Jail (Correctional Officers):** Transfer of \$6,138.82 within correctional officer lines. *Approved by roll call* [00:10:30](#).
 - **Addendum 1 - Commissioners:** Transfer of \$75,000 from health insurance to utilities. *Approved by roll call* [00:11:43](#).

- **Addendum 1 - Jail:** Transfers adjusting medical contracts, inmate meals, and hospital services. *Approved by roll call 00:12:36.*
 - **Bridge / Highway Equipment:** Transfer of \$8,391 from ditch reconstruction to miscellaneous equipment to purchase a second working diesel "hot box" for winter pothole and road repair. *Approved by roll call 00:14:21.*
 - **Highway (Additional):** Truck driver line adjustment of \$9,000. *Approved by roll call 00:15:05.*
 - **Project Income:** Transfer of \$700 from insurance to longevity. *Approved by roll call 00:15:41.*
 - **Surveyor Perpetuation Fund:** Transfer of \$600 from professional services to longevity. *Approved by roll call 00:16:17.*
 - **Addendum 2 - Commissioners:** Transfer of \$70,000 from PERF to institutional care. *(Note: Later discussed for withdrawal/adjustment based on alternative funding). Approved by roll call 00:17:27.*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Individual transfers approved via respective roll call votes. A broad motion to approve financials, transfers, addendums, salary ordinance amendments with line reductions, and an amendment to hiring freeze ordinance 2020-015 passed via roll call 00:28:32.
- **00:18:36 New Appropriations: Coroner**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner department representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$65,000 (\$5,000 for part-time, \$60,000 for autopsy lab/x-ray) drawn from the general fund due to a high volume of full autopsies (24 full autopsies since October 28). The coroner noted that costs remain at \$1,200 per full autopsy and increasing caseloads continue to strain the budget.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote (Yes: Lasseter, Piper, Webb, Ballard, Alexander) 00:24:21.
- **00:23:18 State Prosecutor Seizure Fund Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$1,500 for office supplies using funds derived from state forfeiture accounts. Officials noted this special revenue does not affect the operating balance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote 00:24:21.
- **00:24:33 Auditor Publication Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$3,521 for tax sale publication, which is fully reimbursed.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote 00:25:09.
- **00:25:32 EMS Capital Improvements Appropriation**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Corrected request totaling \$18,950 split into window replacement (\$14,000) and mattress replacement (\$4,950).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote [00:26:53](#).
- **00:27:10 Opioid Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant administrators.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$60,000 (\$32,101 for peer recovery coach, \$4,100 for FICA, \$7,200 for incentives, and \$16,200 for a kiosk), effectively utilizing the remaining balance of the grant fund for the year.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved via roll call vote [00:28:03](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:42:31 Facebook Livestream Viewer:** Asked for clarification regarding whether commissioners want to reduce their salaries to fund three additional county employees. Council members confirmed this understanding.
- **Note:** General board and staff commentary touched upon commissioner salary restructuring proposals, budget tensions, and a reminder from Mr. Webb to warmly welcome newly arriving Afghan refugees settling in Delaware County [00:45:54](#).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council discussed scheduling requirements for December meetings (noting a December 14 date mentioned for upcoming business).
 - Council members and staff exchanged early Happy Thanksgiving wishes.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment was moved by Mr. Ballard, supported by roll call vote (Yes: Ballard, Lasseeter, Piper, Webb, Alexander), and concluded the session alongside reminders to sign pending paperwork [00:46:53](#).